



ICC MEN'S CRICKET WORLD CUP 2023 SEMI FINAL EDITION

**Anish & Spandan attend
the CWC 23 Semis**

**Next Up: Hand Table Tennis
(HTT) World Cup in December**

**WHO WILL MEET
INDIA IN THE
SUMMIT CLASH?**

AUSTRALIA



SEMI - FINAL 2



ICC MEN'S CRICKET WORLD CUP
INDIA 2023

DIL JASHN BOLE



**WE FIVE
FAMILY
SPORTS**



SOUTH AFRICA



**ASSEMBLY
POINT:**

**SCIENCE CITY
@ 12:30 P.M.**



ICC MEN'S
CRICKET WORLD CUP
INDIA 2023



EDEN GARDENS, KOLKATA

DATE/DAY:

THURSDAY

16 NOV 2023

FROM 2 P.M.

**The We Five Family Sports Division marked their
presence on the ongoing Cricket World Cup with its
Platinum Members being in the House during the 2nd
Semi Final held at Eden Gardens between Australia and
South Africa.**

Read on to find out more ...



LOW-SCORING THRILLER AT EDEN

The Eden Gardens in Kolkata played host to the 2nd Semi Final of the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2023 between South Africa and Australia, the 2nd and 3rd ranked teams in the league stage. Spandan and Anish, on behalf of the We Five sporting division, had procured the tickets for the same about 2 months in advance. And certainly we could not regret the purchase, after how things unfolded at this magical clash in the 'City of Joy'.



Both teams entered the game with 2 defeats in their campaign, with SA losing to Netherlands and India, and Australia losing to SA and India. SA's previous win over Australia in the Group Stage could have potentially kept them at a morally advantageous position, but that was ruled out when 'not-fully-fit' Temba Bavuma, the skipper of the Proteas,



chose to bat under overcast conditions, despite the opposition boasting of incredible pacers in Starc and Hazlewood.

The opening Power-play was bossed by the Aussies as the Proteas managed only 18 runs for the loss of 2 wickets. The lack of boundaries in this phase is what costed SA dear, and if not for the Rain Delay (though there wasn't any visible rain), the Proteas looked on course to a double-digit total. Post the rain-break, Miller notched up a fabulous century in tough conditions, which was well appreciated by everyone present. SA looked set for 250 when a double-blow from part-timer Travis Head derailed the run-flow. The late-blitz allowed SA to reach 213 on a pitch that had demons, however we felt it was 20-30 runs short.





A special highlight at the stadium was the availability of free water, alongside delicacies like KFC, Wow Momo and Dominos. However, the accessibility was strenuous as we had to ascend and descend a total of 6 flights go stairs, every time we needed to go for them.

A hilarious moment in the game was a major security breach occurred near the D-block of the stadium which saw a pitch-intruder make his way into the playing area. He attempted to take a selfie with a SA player and waved his hands in the air as if he had won a battle. But his joy turned into agony, when the security personnel caught him. They dragged him across the field and literally threw him like a sack back into the stands, amidst a host of boos and jeers from the enraged crowd.

The Australian pacers garnered a lot of cheer from the crowd upon their initial wickets, but later the support drifted towards South Africa, when everyone in the crowd (majorly from India) realised that the India team had to face this bullish and relentless attack from the Aussies in the Finals, if they advanced.

The rank-turner provided enough thrill in the run-chase too. Contrary to the proceedings, Aussie openers Warner and Head raked up 60 runs

in 6 overs and it looked like the game would be done and dusted in no time. However it was spin-to-win, and Markram struck on his very first ball. Since then, the Aussies were put at sea against the likes of Markram, Maharaj and Shamsi - the Proteas spin attack. A couple of tough dropped chances, and even two easy ones by Quinton behind the stumps in his last ODI game meant that SA lacked the impetus of their initiative. It seemed as if Bavuma got his bowlers and tactics a bit too late, but still made the Aussies struggle for the last 50 runs or so.

The premier bowling pair of Australia, Starc and Cummins took their team over the line this time with the bat, and Australia reached the summit clash, to be played against India at Ahmedabad on 19th November, 2023.

The well-decorated stadium is the home of mystery and magic, every time we visit it. The craze of people in Kolkata is such that the stadium was almost full for the non-India match as well. A beautiful moment was created when the audience swayed their phones and torch-lights in the air to the tunes of the music. The DJ played his part in keeping the ambience vibrant. We enjoyed every moment here and will be waiting for another opportunity to visit this shrine anytime soon.

